The Bridge from Talk to Work

FRICTION POINT 1

FRICTION POINT 2

CAPTURE

ENHANCE

NOTE → WORK CONVERSION

SHARED ARTIFACT → TEAM PULL

EXPANSION

Executive Summary: The Strategy for Team Adoption

WHY THIS FIRST

Fixes the highest-leverage break: Note→Work conversion.

- Leverages existing product strengths
- Precondition for reach + team growth

WHAT WE BUILD

A workflow layer for recurring high-value meetings.

- Detection + Defaults
- Outputs + Memory

HOW WE KNOW IT WORKS

More work gets completed, shared, and repeated.

- More execution-ready notes
- More repeated workflows per workspace

Framework: Capture, Operationalize, Expand (COE)

Capture

Individual value from transcripts and raw notes.

Operationalize

From Note to Execution-Ready Artifact via recipes.

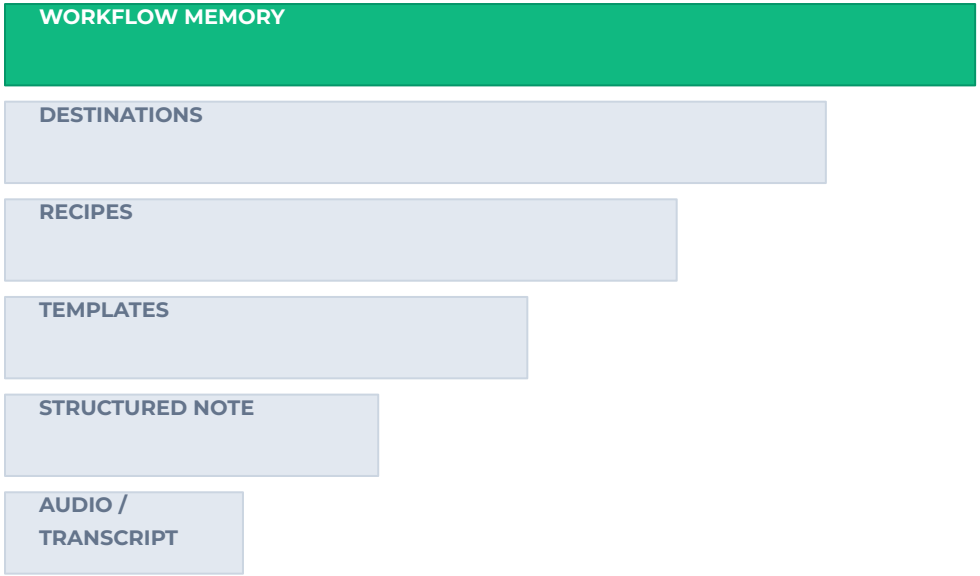
Expand

Reaching the team through shared artifacts.

THE EXPANSION ENGINE

Teammate Value → Workflow Reuse → Team Adoption

Granola’s Latent Execution Potential

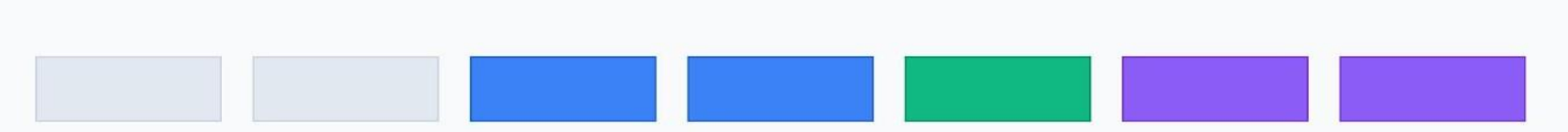


The raw ingredients already exist.

Granola's power isn't in building more AI; it's in composing these layers into a default execution system.

OPPORTUNITY = COMPOSITION, NOT CAPABILITY EXPANSION.

Growth Model: Identifying Critical Value Leakage



Diagnostic Callouts

INDIVIDUAL LEAKAGE

Value stays trapped in the note because recipes/routing are optional.

SYMPTOM: Recipes and routing are manual decisions.

EXPANSION LEAKAGE

Outputs reach surfaces but fail to create *teammate pull*.

SYMPTOM: Outputs are not recipient-optimized enough.

TEAM LEAKAGE

No durable habit due to workflow friction and invisibility.

SYMPTOM: Workflows are not reusable or visible across roles.

Workflow Conversion is the primary first-order bottleneck

HYPOTHESIS	LIKELY SIGNAL	IMPLICATION	WHY NOT FIRST?
Note value weak	*Likely strong note value based on user pattern and satisfaction.*	Note quality is NOT the main break in growth.	Possible, but less likely given current user behavior.
Workflow conversion weak	*Manual routing and optional recipes for recurring meetings.*	**PRIORITY: The first-order activation bottleneck.**	-
Reach expansion weak	*Shared contexts exist but are not defaulted or optimized.*	Downstream bottleneck; requires activation first.	Depends on prior conversion to be effective.
Team expansion weak	*Lack of teammate pull or reusable multi-user defaults.*	Expansion depends on individual activation.	Important, but downstream from workflow activation.

If note satisfaction is already high, workflow conversion becomes the more likely first-order bottleneck.

Chosen constraint must unlock both activation AND expansion.

Two Moments that Matter: Note to Work, and Artifact to Team Pull

MOMENT 1

From Note Value to Work

Converts latent value → actionable output

(Activation unlock)

MOMENT 2

From Shared Artifact to Team Pull

Converts output → organizational value

(Expansion unlock)

TEMPLATE USAGE	RECIPE INVOCATION	SHARED-SURFACE INSERTION	REPEAT WORKFLOW	REPEAT ACROSS TEAM
CONTEXTUAL TRIGGER	WORKFLOW LOGIC	STRUCTURED SOR DATA	HABIT LOOP	MULTI-USER ADOPTION

Constraint Hierarchy: Causal Dependencies for Growth

MONETIZATION	*Premium value depends on activation*
EXPANSION	*No multi-user workflow adoption*
REACH	*Outputs fail to drive recipient action*
BEHAVIORAL	*Power-user behavior not default enough*
UX / ACTIVATION	*Too much manual orchestration*
PRODUCT-SYSTEM	*Toolkit vs composed workflow*

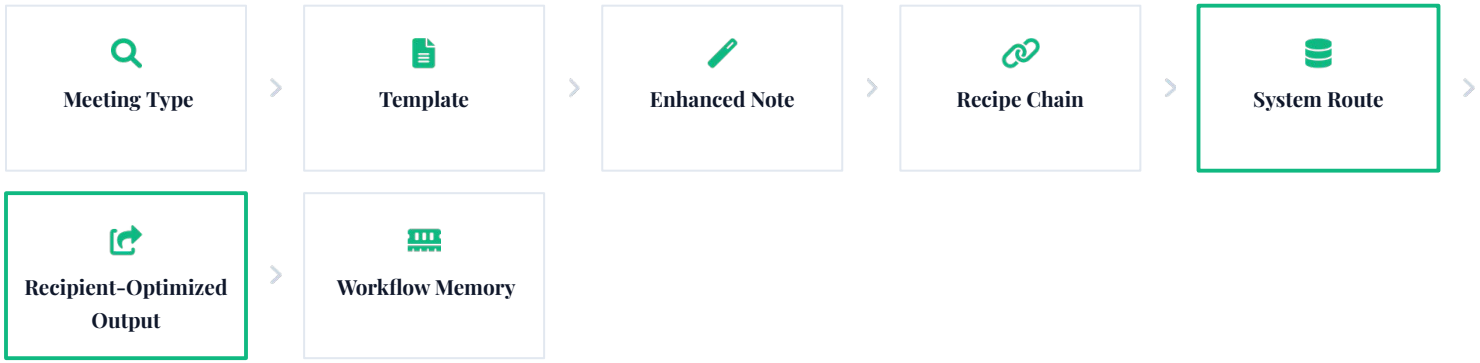
Strategic Causality

Activation and behavioral defaults must be solved first to reach expansion or monetization.

BINDING CONSTRAINT

Premium/business value depends on workflow activation, but those behaviors are not default enough.

Recommendation: *Meeting-to-Execution* Workflows



The strategy shifts from generic routing to **System Route** (structured data for the SOR) and **Recipient-Optimized Output** (share-ready artifacts for the team). The product knows exactly what the team needs to see.

Execution Strategy: MVP Wedge (High-Signal, Low-Cost Entry Point)

COMMERCIAL WORKFLOWS (EXTERNAL-FACING VALUE)

Meeting Type	Default Outputs	Destination
Customer Discovery	**TLDR, pains, issues, next steps**	CRM
Product Demo	**Summary, objections, comms**	CRM
Onboarding	**Action items, setup summary**	CRM / PM

INTERNAL WORKFLOWS (OPERATIONAL VALUE)

Meeting Type	Default Outputs	Destination
Sprint Planning	**Tasks, owners, blockers**	PM tool / Slack
Standup	**Updates, blockers**	Slack
Hiring Interview	**Candidate summary, decision**	Hiring system

Why this wedge?

- High-frequency, **repeatable** meetings → strong habit potential
- Clear downstream outputs → **measurable** conversion
- Obvious system of record (CRM / Slack) → clean routing
- **Low dependency** → fast to ship, reversible

What this wedge proves

- Phase 1: more meetings → execution-ready work
- Phase 2: workflows become repeatable behavior
- Does NOT yet test: team expansion or monetization

This wedge isolates conversion + habit before scaling system complexity

5-Phase Execution Plan: Prove Before You Scale

PHASE 1	PHASE 2	PHASE 3	PHASE 4	PHASE 5
Conversion	**Habit**	**Reach**	**Team**	**Scale**
Meeting → execution-ready output	Repeat workflows become behavior	Outputs enter shared systems	Multiple users adopt workflows	Monetization + system expansion
PRODUCT STATE	**MVP Wedge**	**Workflow Mode**	**Expansion Trigger**	**Team Expansion**	**Monetization**
EXIT SIGNALS	↑ **execution-ready** artifacts	↑ **repeat workflow** usage	↑ **artifacts** in Slack / CRM	↑ **multi-user** workflow usage	↑ **upgrade / limit** pressure

EFFORT SEQUENCING

Phase 1–2: Low cost, high signal (UI + workflow logic)

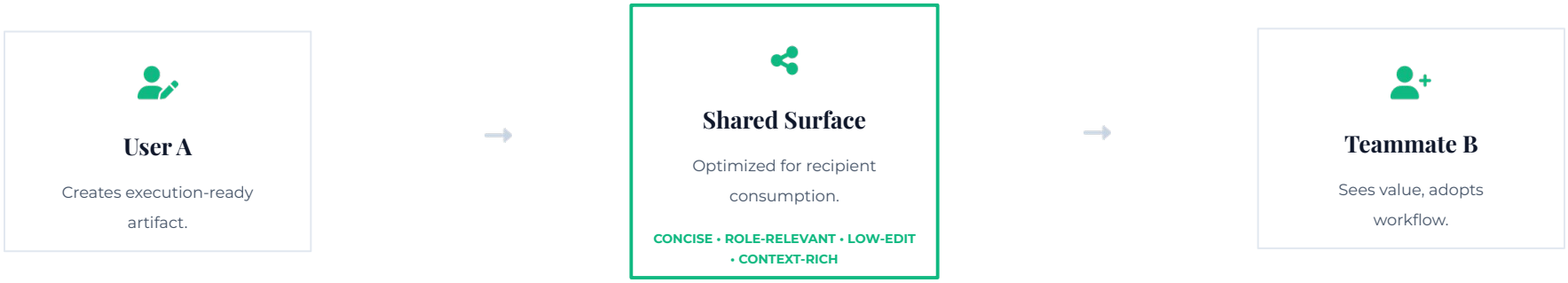
Phase 3–4: Moderate cost (distribution, system insertion)

Phase 5: Highest cost (multi-user + billing)

Prototype: The Seamless *Meeting-to-Execution* Flow

[See Prototype here]

Engineering *Teammate Pull* via Recipient-Optimized Artifacts



Expansion Engine: Artifacts are the distribution mechanism for the product. By making them useful for the recipient, we create a natural pull for the rest of the team.

Experiment Design: Testing the MVP Wedge

CATEGORY	SUCCESS METRIC	TARGET OUTCOME	WHAT IT PROVES
Primary	% of eligible notes converted to execution-ready artifacts	+20% lift in Route / output conversion	Users complete more downstream work
Primary	% of eligible notes converted to share-ready artifacts	+10% lift in shared insertion	Value escapes the note
Habit	Workflow repeat rate	+15% lift in recurring workflow use	Workflow becomes routine
Guardrail	Note satisfaction (CSAT)	Maintain ≥4.5	Core note value remains strong

HYPOTHESIS

Composed workflows will increase execution-ready and share-ready outputs for recurring, high-value meetings.

PILOT SCOPE

Discovery, demo, onboarding, account management.

DESIGN

User-level randomized test.

Control: current note flow.

Treatment: workflow-composed experience.

READ WINDOWS

7d: conversion

14d: repeat use

30d: reach / teammate pull

North Star + Phase-Gate Logic

NORTH STAR METRIC

Weekly Execution-Ready + Share-Ready Workflows per Workspace

This metric compounds across users, workflows, and teams. Scale only if the wedge proves both conversion and repeatability.

ACTIVATION

% Conversion to Execution-Ready Artifacts

HABIT

% Repeat Workflow Use

EXPANSION

% Share-Ready Artifacts Shared to Slack / SOR

Phase 1 Success Thresholds (Scale / Don't Scale)

Conversion

>40% of eligible notes become work outputs.

Repeatability

>25% of users reuse the same workflow.

Satisfaction

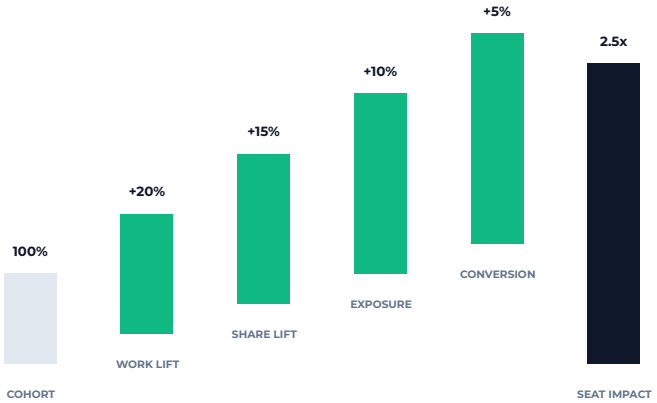
CSAT for Output Quality remains ≥4.5.

Reach

Shared insertion rate improving directionally.

Directional Economics

INCREMENTAL VS BASELINE (ANNUALIZED)



Behavioral lifts compound → 2.5x increase in average active seats per workflow cohort.
Translates to

- ***~1.5K–3K incremental team users***
- ***→ ~500–1.5K monetizable seats***
- ***→ primary driver of ARR expansion***

Illustrative Impact Summary

PATHWAY	ASSUMPTIONS & ARPU	EST. ANNUAL IMPACT
A: Paid Retention Habit-driven retention	7.5K repeat users 8-10% paid conversion	$100K – $125K ARR
B: Premium Clarity Workflow-value upgrade	5K–10K upgrades **$14 ARPU/mo**	$840K – $1.68M ARR
C: Team Expansion New seat conversion	75K–100K exposures 2-3% conv. | **$12-14 ARPU/mo**	$200K – $500K ARR

Calculation notes:

- ***Based on ~500k workflow-eligible users (from 10m total base)***
- ***Derived from +10pt lift in execution-ready outputs and share-ready artifacts***

IMPACT SUMMARY (NET INCREMENTAL, AFTER PATHWAY REALIZATION + OVERLAP ADJ)

Conservative Case	Base Case	Upside Case
$100K – $250K	**$600K – $1.2M**	**$1.5M – $2M+**

**Note: These pathways are not fully additive; Base Case assumes ~40–60% overlap across pathways to prevent double-counting.*

Deliberate Tradeoffs: Maximizing Learning, Avoiding Premature Scaling

TRADEOFF	WHAT WE CHOSE	WHAT WE INTENTIONALLY DID NOT DO
Scope (MVP wedge)	✓ Focus on 2–4 high-value meeting types with clear outputs	✗ Broad coverage across all meeting types
Automation vs Control	✓ Opinionated defaults (auto-structure, auto-output, suggested routing)	✗ Full user customization upfront
Expansion timing	✓ Delay Slack/CRM/system distribution until workflows prove repeatable	✗ Immediate push toward team sharing + invites
Monetization timing	✓ Trigger upgrades only after demonstrated usage + dependency	✗ Early paywalls or generic upsell prompts

Reducing the Gap between Talk and Work

RISK	MITIGATION STRATEGY	RESIDUAL IMPACT
AI Hallucinations	Implement *Review-First* routing for SOR destinations; human-in-the-loop validation.	LOW RISK
Workflow Friction	Automated meeting-type detection and *Zero-Setup* defaults to minimize cognitive load.	MEDIUM RISK
Recommendation Quality	Trusted defaults & user-editable recipe chains to ensure accuracy and user control.	MEDIUM RISK
Data Privacy	Granular sharing controls and role-aware workflow defaults to preserve private context.	LOW RISK

Final Thought:

Granola's next growth unlock is highly likely to come from reducing the friction from meeting intelligence to execution.